

ProSocratic

Complete User Journey Document

Product & Engineering Reference — v1.0

How to read this document. This is a sequential, screen-by-screen walkthrough of the ProSocratic product experience from a new user’s first visit to an ongoing power session weeks later. Each *Phase* represents a distinct product moment. Within each phase, you will find the **UI Moment** (what the user sees), the **System / AI Logic** (what is happening behind the scenes), and notes on transitions and edge cases. Think of this as the product brief, the UX spec, and the story all in one.

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1. Product Philosophy (Read This First)

Before any screen, any agent, any code: what is **ProSocratic** actually trying to do?

Most learning tools are **reactive**. The student arrives confused, types a question, receives an answer, and leaves slightly less confused. The transaction is over. Nothing has changed about the student. They return tomorrow with the same blind spots.

ProSocratic operates on a different premise: **the questions a student never thinks to ask are where 80% of learning loss actually lives**. The student doesn't know what they're missing. Neither does a passive AI. ProSocratic finds the gap *before* the student has named it, surfaces it gently, and then teaches the student how to close it themselves, so they become progressively less dependent on any tool at all.

The avatar companion, *Ori*, is the face of this philosophy: always present, never intrusive, visibly alive only when it genuinely has something worth offering. Every interaction is opt-in. Every suggestion is explained. The student is always in control.

The north star in one sentence: ProSocratic exists to teach you how you learn, so eventually you don't need it.

2. The User: Who We Are Building For

ProSocratic is built exclusively for the **student** — no teacher-facing dashboards in the core flow, no parent oversight, no grading. The user is:

- Secondary to university level, studying independently
- Motivated but frustrated by passive content consumption (reading, re-reading, highlighting)
- Aware that they retain less than they should, but unsure *why*
- Cautious about privacy; doesn't want to be surveilled while they study
- Slightly sceptical of AI tools that promise magic and deliver autocomplete

This is **not** a gamified quiz app. This is not a homework helper. It is a thinking partner that gets smarter about *you* the more you use it.

3. End-to-End Journey Map

Landing → Onboarding → First Session → Profile Emerges → Ongoing Loop → You Dashboard → Independence

Each arrow is a phase described in detail below.

4. Phase-by-Phase Walkthrough

Phase 1: The Landing *First impression. 0 seconds of data.*

The user arrives at **prosocratic.ai** from a link, ad, or word of mouth. They have no account. They know nothing about the product.

UI Moment: The Homepage

The page is calm. No hero animation that screams “AI-powered!” No feature list in three-column bullet grids. Just a single, still question centred on the screen:

“What if the thing you don’t know to ask is the thing that matters most?”

Below it, a single call-to-action: **Start learning. It’s free.**

Beneath that, in small grey text: *No camera. No account required to try. Your data stays on your device.*

In the bottom-right corner, barely visible: a small illustrated creature — *Ori* — curled up, eyes closed, softly breathing. Not blinking. Not animated. Just present.

System / AI Logic: Nothing yet

No tracking. No fingerprinting. No cookie banner. The system has collected zero data at this stage. The privacy promise begins here, visibly.

Design intent: The curled, sleeping *Ori* is the product’s first statement about its philosophy. It does not demand attention. It waits. The student will come to understand this is how the whole product behaves.

Phase 2: Onboarding *Building the first sketch of who you are.*

The user clicks **Start learning**. No email required yet. They are dropped into a short, conversational onboarding — not a form, not a survey, but a brief exchange with *Ori*.

UI Moment: The First Conversation

Ori opens one eye. A thought bubble appears:

“Before we start — what are you studying right now? Just tell me the subject, or paste in a topic you’ve been staring at.”

The student types freely: *“Cellular respiration, biology A-levels”*

Ori:

“Got it. One more thing — when you’re stuck, do you usually want someone to explain it to you, or would you rather figure it out yourself with a nudge?”

- Explain it to me *(maps to: procedural / direct learner)*
- Give me a nudge and I’ll find it *(maps to: exploratory / Socratic learner)*
- Depends on how stuck I am *(maps to: hybrid learner)*

That’s it. Two exchanges. No birth date, no school, no email. The student is in.

System / AI Logic: Archetype Seed

The system creates a local session profile with two seed values:

- **Domain:** Biology / Cellular Respiration
- **Archetype seed:** Hybrid (exploratory leaning)

This is a hypothesis, not a verdict. The real archetype will be built from behaviour over the next 15–20 minutes. All data is stored locally; nothing leaves the device until the user explicitly creates an account.

Phase 3: The First Session *The product earns trust in real time.*

The student is now in the main study workspace. This is where the product lives or dies.

3.1 The Workspace Layout

UI Moment: Study Canvas

The workspace is split into two regions:

Left panel (70%): The study area. The student can paste notes, upload a PDF, type a question, or simply start asking. The interface looks like a clean text environment — not a chat window, not a dashboard.

Right panel (30%): *Ori's* space. The avatar sits in the top-right. Below it, a small status indicator shows what mode ProSocratic is currently in: *Listening, Noticing, Has something*. At the very bottom of the right panel is a one-line transparency strip: *"Why I'm about to say something — click to see."* It only appears when the system has detected something worth surfacing.

Ori is asleep again. Silent. Watching.

3.2 The Student Asks a Question

UI Moment: First Interaction

The student types: *"What is cellular respiration?"*

ProSocratic answers. Cleanly, accurately, without padding. One paragraph.

Then — and this is the moment — before the student can move on, a single follow-up line appears beneath the answer in a slightly different colour:

"You asked what it is. You didn't ask why your cells would die within seconds without it. That part's actually more interesting — want me to go there?"

Two options appear as soft buttons: **Yes, go there** **No, keep going**

System / AI Logic: Unasked Question Engine — First Trigger

The system has detected that the student asked a definitional question (“what is X”). The Unasked Question Engine flags a high-value adjacent concept (urgency / cellular survival) that most students never explicitly request but which significantly deepens understanding.

The suggestion is **non-interruptive**: it appears after the answer, not instead of it. The student has already received what they asked for. This is just an offer of more.

If the student says Yes: The system shifts into a Socratic thread — not explaining survival, but asking the student to reason it out: “*What do you think would happen to a cell if ATP production stopped completely?*”

If the student says No: The system notes the skip. If the same gap surfaces again later, it will try once more with a different entry point.

3.3 Confusion Is Detected (No Camera)

UI Moment: Behavioural Signal Moment

Ten minutes into the session. The student is reading about the Krebs cycle. They’ve scrolled up and back down twice. Their typing pauses have grown longer. They typed three words, deleted them, started again. They haven’t submitted a question in two minutes.

Ori shifts. One eye opens. The status strip at the bottom of the right panel now reads: “*Ori notices something.*” A faint amber spark appears near the avatar — the visual motif for “I have something when you’re ready.”

Nothing else happens. The student decides whether to click.

System / AI Logic: State Detection — Confusion (0.91 confidence)

The behavioral classifier has flagged the following signals:

- Scroll-back pattern detected (same section, twice)
- Keystroke abandon rate: 3 abandoned attempts in 90 seconds
- Idle period: 2 min 10 sec
- Navigation: no forward progression in 4 minutes

Classified state: **CONFUSION** at confidence 0.91. The system selects a Feynman Technique intervention (matched to hybrid archetype + first-session recency). *Ori* signals availability without interrupting.

UI Moment: The Student Clicks Ori

The right panel expands slightly. A transparency card appears:

Why Ori is awake:

You've been on this section for 4 minutes without moving forward. The backtracking pattern usually means something isn't clicking — not that you're not trying.

What might help: The Feynman Technique. You explain it to me in plain language. The gaps in your explanation show exactly where the understanding breaks.

What it takes: About 2 minutes. You talk, I listen, then I ask one question.

[Try it] [Not right now] [Show me a diagram instead] [Just explain it to me]

The student picks **Show me a diagram instead**.

System / AI Logic: Modality Switch — Text to Visual

The system notes the preference: when confused + reading text, this student prefers visual modality. Archetype updated: **visual-hybrid**. An animated diagram of the Krebs cycle renders in the left panel — interactive, annotated, with clickable steps. The text is not removed; it remains scrollable beside the diagram.

3.4 The Insight Moment**UI Moment: The “Aha” Moment**

The student clicks through the diagram. They pause on the NAD^+/NADH step. Their typing accelerates — they write: *“Wait, so the whole point of the Krebs cycle is just to recharge NAD^+ ? That's what we're actually doing here?”*

Ori fully wakes up. A small sparkle animation plays around the avatar — the visual motif for an insight moment.

ProSocratic responds:

“Exactly that. Write that in your own words, right now, before we move. Don't worry about being precise — just your version of it.”

Then: *“Now explain it to me like I'd never heard of ATP before.”*

System / AI Logic: Insight Capture + Elaboration Protocol

State transitions to **INSIGHT_MOMENT**. The system triggers two sequential actions:

1. **Capture:** Student writes their own formulation. This is stored locally as a “personal definition” anchoring the concept.
2. **Elaboration:** Teach-back prompt deepens the understanding before it solidifies into passive recognition.

The Unasked Question Engine simultaneously queues the next adjacent gap: *“What happens to all this NADH in the electron transport chain?”* — the concept that 70% of students who understand Krebs still can't connect forward.

What this is not: This is not a grade. It is not a score out of 100. It is not a comparison to other students. It is an evolving self-portrait of how *this* student thinks and learns, written so the student can read it and recognise themselves.

Phase 5: Independence *The product succeeds when you need it less.*

After consistent use over several weeks, something subtle has happened. The student no longer waits for ProSocratic to surface what they're missing. They start asking the adjacent questions themselves. They notice when they're skimming. They reach for the Feynman technique before Ori suggests it.

UI Moment: The Farewell Card (Optional)

At some point — if the student's own self-initiated question quality has measurably improved, if they're catching their own gaps before the system does — *Ori* surfaces a card:

"Something has changed. You've started asking the questions I used to ask for you. That's the point. I'm still here, but you might not need me the same way. That's good."

No upsell. No streak pressure. No "don't lose your progress." Just an honest acknowledgment that the tool worked.

Why this matters for the product: This is the final and most important design constraint. The product must be built in a way that *does not* create dependency. Every intervention should transfer agency to the student, not accumulate it in the system. The farewell card is not a marketing feature — it is the product's proof of concept.

5. Edge Cases and Behavioural Rules

Situation	System Response
Student ignores Ori three times in a row	Ori goes back to sleep for the rest of the session. No fourth attempt.
Student asks for the answer directly	System provides it, then asks: <i>“I’ll give you the answer — but can I ask you one question after? It’ll take 30 seconds and it’s the part that makes it stick.”</i>
Student is visibly rushing (high scroll speed, rapid questions, no dwell)	Ori surfaces once: <i>“You’re moving fast. That’s fine. But fast and retained are different. Want me to run a quick check at the end of this topic?”</i>
Student tries the same modality three times without understanding	Ori escalates to a different modality automatically, with a note: <i>“Text isn’t clicking here. Let me try showing you instead.”</i>
Student reports frustration explicitly	System switches immediately to direct explanation mode. No Socratic questioning until the student is unblocked.
Student attempts a topic outside their stated subject	System adapts without comment. The learner profile expands to include the new domain.
Session runs longer than 45 min without a break	Ori suggests a break using the student’s personalised Pomodoro interval. One suggestion only.

6. Privacy Architecture in the User Experience

Privacy is not a legal disclaimer buried in settings. It is a first-class design element visible throughout the journey.

No camera, ever. This is stated on the landing page, on the onboarding screen, and in the transparency card whenever a mindset detection fires. The student should never have to wonder if they’re being watched.

Local by default. All behavioral signals are processed on-device. The learner profile lives locally. No server sees raw interaction data.

Transparent state declarations. Every time the system detects a state and surfaces a suggestion, it shows the student exactly which behavioral signals triggered it. Nothing is hidden behind “our algorithm thinks...”.

Differential privacy for optional sharing. If a student opts into anonymised improvement sharing (helping ProSocratic learn what techniques work for others like them), the contribution is mathematically anonymised using a Laplace mechanism with $\varepsilon = 0.7$ before it ever leaves the device.

Delete means delete. If a student deletes their account, their profile, learner fingerprint, and insight anchors are destroyed. There is no “we retain anonymised signals” caveat.

7. Ori — The Avatar: Behavioural Specification

Ori is not a mascot. It is the product's primary communication layer. Its behaviour must be specified precisely.

State	Animation	Meaning
Idle / Student in flow	Eyes closed, slow breathing	"I'm here, nothing to surface right now"
Noticing (signal detected, sub-threshold)	One eye slightly open	"Something may be worth flagging soon"
Has something (intervention ready)	Both eyes open, slight lean forward, amber spark	"I have something when you're ready"
Insight detected	Sparkle burst, tail wag or equivalent	"That was a real understanding moment"
Fatigue detected	Soft yawn animation	"Your focus is dropping. Break?"
Student frustrated (explicit signal)	Ears flatten, steps back	"Switching to direct explanation mode"
Farewell / independence card	Stretches, opens fully, then settles peacefully	"The product worked"

The single most important rule for Ori: It should never feel like it's performing. Every animation is a genuine signal about what the system knows and what it's offering. If the student is in flow and nothing is worth surfacing, Ori sleeps. That silence is intentional, and it is the thing that makes the moments when Ori wakes up feel meaningful.

8. Summary: The Six Principles Behind Every Design Decision

1. **The best intervention is one the student chooses.** ProSocratic never forces. Every suggestion is opt-in. Consent is the architecture.
2. **Answer first, then go deeper.** The student always gets what they asked for. Exploration of unasked questions is offered, not substituted.
3. **Transparency is not a settings page.** Every detection, every suggestion, every mode switch — shown in plain language at the moment it happens.
4. **Disagreement is a form of respect.** When the student is wrong or overconfident, ProSocratic says so. Gently, with evidence, with an alternative. But it says so.
5. **No camera. No comparison. No judgment.** The student's learning fingerprint is theirs. It is never shown against others. It never leaves the device without explicit consent.
6. **The goal is independence.** If the student needs ProSocratic less after six weeks than after one, that is the product working correctly.

This document is a living reference. Update it as product decisions evolve.
If a feature you are building is not described here, ask: does it serve the student's independence, or
undermine it?

“Teach them how to learn. Then let them go.”

